

Vladimir Zakharov

*Machine Learning Engineer /
Computer Science Student*

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Summary

Machine Learning Engineer with experience in recommendation and search suggestion quality improvement, LLM training/distillation, and production integration (C++). Strong background in applied mathematics and computer science; interested in end-to-end ML systems: from data generation and modeling to efficient inference and deployment.

Education

2022– **BSc in Applied Mathematics and Computer Science**, *HSE University (Higher School of Economics)*, Saint Petersburg Campus, Saint Petersburg, Russia

(expected) **Relevant coursework:** C/C++, Python, Algorithms and Data Structures, Computer Architecture and Operating Systems, SQL, Numerical Methods, Discrete Mathematics, Calculus, Linear Algebra, Probability and Mathematical Statistics, ODEs, Machine Learning.

Skills

Programming Python, C/C++, Java

ML/DL PyTorch, Transformers, NLP, LLM fine-tuning/distillation, classical ML

Tools Linux, Git, SQL

Languages Russian (native), English (B1)

Other Driver's license: Category B

Work experience

Mar **ML Engineer**, VK, Russia

2026– Improving the quality of feed recommendations.
present

Feb **ML Engineer**, Yandex, Moscow, Russia

2025– Worked on improving geo-suggest (place suggestions by typed prefix). Responsibilities included:
Feb 2026

- Training/fine-tuning/distillation of both LLMs and classical models
- Backend development and integration of trained models into production (C++)
- Running and analyzing A/B tests
- Building dashboards
- Developing online and offline service quality metrics

Dec **C++ Course Teaching Assistant**, HSE University, Moscow, Russia

2023– Graded C++ programming assignments and provided feedback to students.
Dec 2025

- Jul 2024– **Engineering Intern (ASR)**, YADRO, Moscow, Russia
- Feb 2025 Worked in an Automatic Speech Recognition team. Key results:
- Accelerated meeting transcription pipeline by **30%**
 - Reduced an on-device ASR model size by **1.25×**
- Nov **Research Assistant**, Chebyshev Laboratory, Saint Petersburg, Russia
- 2024– Rewrote a gas recognition pipeline from Python to C for deployment on a Raspberry Pi controller.
- Dec 2024
- Sep **Research Intern**, Social and Cognitive Informatics Laboratory, Saint Petersburg, Russia
- 2024– Research on using LLMs to solve differential equations:
- Dec 2025
- Data generation and labeling
 - Training large language models for differential equation solving

Olympiads & Competitive programming

- 2022 **Kurchatov Olympiad in Mathematics**, Finals — 3rd degree diploma
- 2022 **Joint Interuniversity Mathematical Olympiad**, Finals — 3rd degree diploma
- 2022 **Granit of Science Olympiad (Natural Sciences)**, Finals — 3rd degree diploma
- LeetCode**, 232 problems solved

Other

Graduate of Lyceum No. 239 (Saint Petersburg); awarded “Golden Owl” and “Atlant” insignia.

Former professional ski jumper; member of the Saint Petersburg team.